



CALICUT UNIVERSITY – FOUR-YEAR UNDERGRADUATE PROGRAMME

(CU-FYUGP)

BA ENGLISH LANGUAGE AND LITERATURE HONOURS

Programme	BA ENGLISH LANGUAGE AND LITERATURE HONOURS				
Course Code	ENG6EJ308				
Course Title	INTRODUCTION TO DISABILITY STUDIES				
Type of Course	ELECTIVE				
Semester	VI				
Academic Level	300-399				
Course Details	Credit	Lecture per week	Tutorial per week	Practical per week	Total Hours
	4	4	-	-	60
Pre-requisites	The learner should have a basic understanding of the various perspectives of Disability Studies in Literature.				
Course Summary	It is estimated that about 15% of the world's population lives with disabilities. It is essential to develop an understanding of the experiences of persons with disability and caregivers. This course is designed to explore the nuances of the language used to define and talk about persons with disabilities and to explore the social dimensions of living with disabilities and issues of accessibility. The course aims to equip the learners with a critical awareness of the lives of persons with disabilities and open up a discourse on societal changes that are needed to guarantee all the rights of persons with disabilities to live as full citizens.				

Course Outcomes (CO):

CO	CO Statement	Cognitive Level*	Knowledge Category#	Evaluation Tools used
CO1	Define and discuss the social construction of disability	U	C	Exam
CO2	Apply Disability Studies Perspectives to Real-World Contexts	Ap	P	Seminar/Group Project
CO3	Analyze disability as a social justice issue	An	C	Exam/quizzes/Assignment
CO4	Critically analyze the nuances of the language associated with disability	An	C	Exam/Seminar
CO5	Critically evaluate representations of disability in Media and Culture	E	P	Exams/Assignments
CO6	Develop Empathy and Respect for Diverse Disability Experiences	C	M	JAM/Writing assignments/Group Project
* - Remember (R), Understand (U), Apply (Ap), Analyse (An), Evaluate (E), Create (C) # - Factual Knowledge(F) Conceptual Knowledge (C) Procedural Knowledge (P) Metacognitive Knowledge (M)				

Detailed Syllabus:

Module	Unit	Content	Hrs	Marks
				70
I	DISABILITY AND LANGUAGE		12	18
	1	What is disability? - Disabled body - Ableism - person first language versus identity-first language - language and stigma - inclusivity	4	
	2	Selections from <i>Stigma</i> - Erving Goffman - <i>The Disability Studies Reader</i> , Ed. Lennard J Davies	4	
	3	NIH Entry on Person-first and Destigmatizing Language (Person-first and Destigmatizing Language National Institutes of Health (NIH)) and Cara Liebowitz - I am Disabled: On Identity-First Versus People-First Language	2	
	4	I'm not your inspiration, thank you very much-TED x Sydney (Stella Young: I'm not your inspiration, thank you very much TED Talk)- Stella Young	2	
	Suggested Activity: Discussion on the various words and phrases in English and regional languages that denote disabilities and often are used derogatively.			

II	DISABILITY AND SOCIETY		12	18
	5	False consciousness - Caregiving and disability - Overcoming stigma - social model of disability	4	
	6	The Social Construction of the Disability Problem (Excerpts) - <i>The Politics of Disablement</i> - Michael Oliver	3	
	7	I won't Break - Michael Morrell	2	
	8	Laughing in the face of disability - Tunesco - The New Yorker Documentary https://youtu.be/GsSMMG6eC4g?si=DxSBHvuMB6baox40	3	
	Suggested Activity: 1. Meet and interact with persons of disabilities in your communities to learn more about how persons with disabilities perceive their role in the society. 2. Interact with caregivers and understand the ways in which caregivers rationalise the task of caregiving.			
III	DISABILITY AND ACCESSIBILITY		12	17
	9	Disability and access through technology; Disability and access to work; Accessible spaces	3	
	10	The Social Model of Disability- Tom Shakespeare - <i>The Disability Studies Reader</i> , Ed. Lennard J Davies	3	
	11	Accessible Cities for People with Disabilities - Manisha Natarajan, Nidhi Ashok Goyal, and Dikshu Kukreja, NDTV (https://www.ndtv.com/video/property/the-urban-agenda/accessible-cities-for-people-with-disabilities-734874)	3	
	12	What Does a Truly Disabled-Accessible City Look Like? (<i>The Guardian</i>) -Saba Salman - (https://www.theguardian.com/cities/2018/feb/14/what-disability-accessible-city-look-like)	3	

	Suggested Activity: Map out the spaces of your own homes, university, institution, or a public place of your choice in order to understand whether those spaces are constructed considering the needs of persons with various disabilities. What can be done to make these spaces truly inclusive and disabled-accessible?		
IV	REPRESENTATIONS OF DISABILITY		12
	13	Perspectives on disability; who represents the disabled	3
	14	Representation and its Discontents: The Uneasy Home of Disability in Literature and Film - David T Mitchell and Sharon L Snyder (195-215)	3
	15	<i>Pitied and Desexualized: How Malayalam Cinema has Portrayed People with Disability</i> -Neelima Menon	3
	16	<i>Margarita with a Straw</i> - Shonali Bose	3
	Suggested Activity: We are living in an era of superhero films and fiction. Learners can be encouraged to choose superheroes with disabilities (from a comic, film, or some other media) and make a presentation on their chosen character with a focus on the kind of disability being represented, whether the representation is positive, and how it affects audience perception of persons with disability.		
V	OPEN ENDED		12

Note: The course is divided into five modules, with four having total 16 fixed units and one open-ended module with a variable number of units. There are total 48 instructional hours for the fixed modules and 12 hours for the open-ended one. Internal assessments (30 marks) are split between the open-ended module (10 marks) and the fixed modules (20 marks). The final exam, however, covers only the 16 units from the fixed modules.

Suggested Readings:

1. *The Disability Studies Reader* – Lennard J Davis (anthology)
2. “The Struggle for Citizenship: The Case of Disabled People” *Disability, Handicap & Society* by L Barton
3. Disability Representation in Film - featuring Matthew Alaniz [Disability Representation in Film - featuring Matthew Alaniz \(Part 2\) \[CC\] \[AD\]](#)
4. Stephen Hawking – *My Brief History*
5. *The Rejected Body: Feminist Philosophical Reflections on Disability* – Susan Wendell
6. *Extraordinary bodies: Figuring Physical Disability in American Culture and Literature* - Rosemarie Garland Thomson
7. Disability Representation in Film, TV and on Stage - AMI Accessible Media Inc [Disability Representation in film, TV and on stage](#)
8. “The Body in Culture, Technology and Society” by Chris Shilling
9. Nilika Mehrotra - “Disability Rights and Movements in India: Politics and Practice”
10. “Disabled Women: An Excluded Agenda of Indian Feminism”- Anita Ghai -
11. *Contours of Ableism: The Production of Disability and Abledness*- Fiona Kumari Campbell
12. *The Politics of Disabledness*- Michael Olive

Mapping of COs with PSOs and POs:

	P S O 1	P S O 2	P S O 3	P S O 4	P S O 5	P S O 6	P S O 7	P S O 8	P S O 9	P O 1	P O 2	P O 3	P O 4	P O 5	P O 6	P O 7
CO 1	-	-	-	-	3	-	-	-	-	-	2	-	-	-	2	-
CO 2	2	-	3	-	3	-	-	-	-	2	-	-	-	3	3	-
CO 3	-	-	3	-	3	-	-	-	-	2	2	-	-	2	3	-
CO 4	-	1	3	-	3	-	-	-	-	2	3	-	-	3	2	-
CO 5	-	-	3	2	3	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	2	3	2
CO 6	-	-	2	-	3	-	-	-	-	-	2	-	-	2	3	-

Correlation Levels:

Level	Correlation
-	Nil
1	Slightly / Low
2	Moderate / Medium
3	Substantial / High

Assessment:

1. Quiz/ Discussion/ Seminar (10%)
2. Internal Exam (10%)
3. Assignment (10%)
4. End Semester Exam (70%)

Mapping of Cos to Assessment Rubrics:

	Quiz/ Discussion/ Seminar (10%)	Internal Exam (10%)	Assignment (10%)	End Semester Exam (70%)
CO 1	✓	✓	✓	✓
CO 2	✓	✓	✓	✓
CO 3	✓	✓	✓	✓
CO 4	✓	✓	✓	✓
CO 5	✓	✓	✓	✓
C06	✓	✓	✓	✓